Axis Tripod also helps you get your bearings when you are looking at camera and perspective views. By default, there are four viewports named Top, Left, Front, and Perspective, as indicated by the labels in the upper left corners of each viewport. You can also tell that the Perspective viewport is different from the others by the way the grid squares get smaller and converge in the distance. You can configure and view your model in a variety of ways, depending on your needs using the different viewport settings.

1.3.1 Shading

Each viewport can a different type of shading set associated with it. Similarly, you can have a different view in each viewport. This is very helpful since you can see different sections of a particular scene in different styles. While modelling, you may choose the wireframe mode. Similarly, while rendering, you can choose any of the shaded modes. The quality of shading depicted depends on your computer's graphics card as well as the graphics mode. For example, Direct3D drivers are much faster and will show more realistic textures and transparencies, whereas OpenGL drivers are faster for deforming meshes, used in character animation.

The Wireframe mode shows a basic outline of the object; Smooth, the object rendered; and Wireframe On Shaded, the wireframe superimposed on a shaded object. The Facets mode shows the model without smoothing, with polygonal edges visible. Flat eliminates shading for a more 2D look. Bounding Box creates a box around the object. Bounding Box is great for navigating complex scenes that update slowly in rather detailed modes.

1.3.2 Navigation

You can navigate using a mouse, or by the navigation bar at the bottom-right corner of the screen. Mouse navigation is accomplished by using the middle button along with the keyboard. The navigation bar at the bottom-right corner of the screen contains additional navigation tools. Middle-click and drag, to pan the viewport. Rolling the middle button zooms into the object. If the mouse does not have a rolling middle button, press [Ctrl]+[Alt] while pressing the middle button to zoom. Hold down the [Ctrl] key while pressing the middle button to rotate around the scene.

1.3.3 Selecting Objects

3ds Max has a wide range of object types that includes geometry, lights, cameras, and bones. You can select objects individually, by group, and by name. Objects can be selected individually or in groups by using the mouse.